

Top 50 Docker Commands

Day 12 • 100 Days of DevOps Series • Quick Reference Cheat Sheet

IMAGE COMMANDS

#	Command	Description
1	<code>docker build -t name:tag .</code>	Build image from Dockerfile
2	<code>docker images</code>	List local images
3	<code>docker image inspect image</code>	Show image metadata
4	<code>docker image history image</code>	Show image layer history
5	<code>docker tag src dst</code>	Tag an image
6	<code>docker pull image</code>	Pull image from registry
7	<code>docker push image</code>	Push image to registry
8	<code>docker rmi image</code>	Remove an image
9	<code>docker save -o file.tar image</code>	Export image to tar archive

CONTAINER LIFECYCLE

#	Command	Description
10	<code>docker run image</code>	Run a new container
11	<code>docker run -d image</code>	Run container in detached mode
12	<code>docker run -it image bash</code>	Run interactive container with shell
13	<code>docker run -p 8080:80 image</code>	Map host port to container port
14	<code>docker run -v /host:/cont image</code>	Bind mount a volume
15	<code>docker run --env-file .env image</code>	Pass env vars from file
16	<code>docker run --name name image</code>	Assign a container name
17	<code>docker run --restart=always image</code>	Set restart policy
18	<code>docker start container</code>	Start a stopped container
19	<code>docker stop container</code>	Gracefully stop a container
20	<code>docker restart container</code>	Restart a container
21	<code>docker kill container</code>	Force-kill a container
22	<code>docker rm container</code>	Remove a container

MONITORING & DEBUGGING

#	Command	Description
23	<code>docker ps</code>	List running containers
24	<code>docker ps -a</code>	List all containers (incl. stopped)
25	<code>docker exec -it container bash</code>	Open shell inside running container

#	Command	Description
26	<code>docker logs container</code>	View container logs
27	<code>docker logs -f container</code>	Stream container logs live
28	<code>docker inspect container</code>	Show detailed container/image JSON
29	<code>docker stats</code>	Live resource usage of containers
30	<code>docker top container</code>	Show running processes in container
31	<code>docker cp container:/path ./local</code>	Copy files from container to host
32	<code>docker diff container</code>	Show filesystem changes in container
33	<code>docker commit container image</code>	Create image from container state

VOLUMES

#	Command	Description
34	<code>docker volume create name</code>	Create a named volume
35	<code>docker volume ls</code>	List volumes
36	<code>docker volume inspect name</code>	Inspect volume details
37	<code>docker volume rm name</code>	Remove a volume

NETWORKING

#	Command	Description
38	<code>docker network ls</code>	List networks
39	<code>docker network create name</code>	Create custom network
40	<code>docker network inspect name</code>	Inspect network details
41	<code>docker network connect net container</code>	Attach container to network

COMPOSE

#	Command	Description
42	<code>docker compose up -d</code>	Start services from compose file
43	<code>docker compose down</code>	Stop and remove compose services
44	<code>docker compose logs -f</code>	Stream logs from all compose services

REGISTRY, SYSTEM & CLEANUP

#	Command	Description
45	<code>docker login registry</code>	Authenticate to a registry
46	<code>docker system df</code>	Show Docker disk usage
47	<code>docker system prune -a</code>	Remove unused data (aggressive)
48	<code>docker container prune</code>	Remove all stopped containers

#	Command	Description
49	<code>docker image prune -a</code>	Remove all unused images
50	<code>docker volume prune</code>	Remove unused volumes
51	<code>docker network prune</code>	Remove unused networks

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